

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] All right. All right. So thank you again for participating in this interview. And as mentioned over email, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. And we believe that your experience and perspectives would bring much to the project. So first, we're going to start off with demographics. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:22] I'm [16-20] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:25] Okay. And how long have you been together with your partner? Um.

Speaker 2 [00:00:29] Like [1-5] year.

Speaker 1 [00:00:32] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] Like [6-10] months.

Speaker 1 [00:00:38] Okay. All right. And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:46] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:48] And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:51] It's my mom, Dad. Me, my brother.

Speaker 1 [00:00:59] And what is your main source of income or your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:02] Uh, my job. Alrighty. I work like a [occupation]. Like a [company]. [Company].

Speaker 1 [00:01:12] All right. And. What would you like me to address to your partner? Boyfriend. Partner. Lover. By name.

Speaker 2 [00:01:21] My boyfriend. Just. Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:01:25] And okay, so from now on, it's mainly me just taking notes and talking about the words and stuff like that. So tell me about your love story.

Speaker 2 [00:01:38] All right. So we met because I was working at [Country] before, and it was like it was literally like my last week working. And I was walking. I was a [occupation] there. So I was walking back to my place. And then I guess I don't know you and as me. And then he was like, oh. And he was like, How old are you? And I thought it was me. And I was like, Oh, I was like [16-20]. I was like, I'm [16-20]. He was like, he's like, Oh, when I do, you had you have the phone number of [Social Media]. And I was like, Shit. And the weird thing is like, I never give my phone number or anything to people. I'm just like, Oh, sorry. I know, I'm sorry. And but I don't know why. For him, I was like, okay, fine, sure as I gave it to him. And then that night we talked on the phone until like four in the morning was crazy and we just kept talking more and more. And for [6-10] months, I mean, right away, though, we were kind of like being acting like a couple instead of taking it slow, whatever. But [6-10] months later, he asked me to be his girlfriend in [Month]. So. Yeah, those.

Speaker 1 [00:02:46] Oh nice. Okay. Right. So you mentioned that you guys talk and kind of like acted like a couple. Was there like, any reason for you to say maybe I am already a girlfriend? Or was it just like, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:03:18] Okay. Because like the first [1-5] weeks I had a party at my house and he came to my house because it was really late and it was like, oh, you just go to my house because it's closer to for your mom to pick you up instead of going all the way over where we were at. That's why he came to my house. So he met my mom, my dad. He knew like, they knew what we were doing, going out where he was kind of. And so that was like really fast. And I was like, whatever. And then he came. I saw my cousin because there was a party in my house and then everybody knew. And so, like, just immediately it was like, Oh, you and your boyfriend? Like, they just called him my boyfriend, even though we weren't together. Together. Yeah. And then just like everybody knew, we were talking and they were just assumed, like, oh, boyfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:04:07] That's cute. All right, so how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:04:21] Honestly, I think in the beginning it was kind of like, I'm all my friends, their relationships are kind of like hard and stuff, but just to be normal, mine was so I just think my quality is pretty average. It was hard in the beginning, but like after like a few months, just everything settled down and we were like, perfectly fine. Obviously we still get into arguments, stupid arguments, but it's like, not bad. So I feel like it's a good quality compared to my friends. So yeah, I don't.

Speaker 1 [00:04:52] And you mention like some arguments like how do you like, what are the arguments about basically?

Speaker 2 [00:05:05] So he's kind of like the type of person who shuts down and needs space and time and like by himself to be able to talk, I guess. But I like in the moment I'm like, no, like, why are you going to ignore me? You're just putting it out like, you need to talk to me. Are you going to denounce me? So that's, I would argue because he's like, Oh, I need time because I need to process this and I don't want to say anything like rude or anything, so you have to leave for being. But I'm like, No, but how are you going to do that? If you want to be with me, you have to talk to me. So it would just be like that.

Speaker 1 [00:05:36] Got it. All right. And can I also ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:05:44] And just [1-5], just [1-5] before. And then him.

Speaker 1 [00:05:50] And how would you compare the quality of your relationship, of your the current relationship you have right now compared to your previous relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:00] Hmm. The previous one, it wasn't really anything serious. I don't really count it most of the time. It's just I was like a [year] and I had met him and we talked and then we would hang out sometimes. But it was never anything like serious. He only met my mom. Just on [Event]. And yeah, it was it was just a really small thing.

Speaker 1 [00:06:22] Mm. And what exactly what do you think would be the thing that determines whether a relationship is serious or not?

Speaker 2 [00:06:34] I feel like the way you guys like maybe like the way you treat each other. Because the one before, like me and the other guy, are you going to talk about anything serious or just like, oh, how's your day? And then I was there. But we never really

got into anything deep. And then this one. He's always there for me. You know, he just knows. I don't know. It's just. They just know.

Speaker 1 [00:07:04] All right. All right, so you kind of mentioned this, but you could repeat it again. But what makes our relationship high quality and low quality and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:07:24] I feel like high quality would be like actually getting through situations and not putting them off. That's something I always want to work on. I'm always like, We can just leave things or if they just add up and if they do, I don't like obviously it could go to like something bad. So I feel like the credibility, if you actually talk through with the person and then look quality, obviously if you don't if you just if one person looks at other like, oh, I doesn't really matter, I don't care, then I'm not going to put my mind to it.

Speaker 1 [00:08:03] When would you say your relationship was? Like the highest in terms of communication or getting through the situations that you mentioned, and compared to low quality--

Speaker 2 [00:08:20] I feel like the highest it was, or probably like in the beginning of this year, like around maybe like [Month], [Month], they started getting better or just, they just felt more normal.

Speaker 1 [00:08:38] What is--

Speaker 2 [00:08:39] The what? Yeah?

Speaker 1 [00:08:41] Yeah. Just to add on to that. What? How do you define normal?

Speaker 2 [00:08:45] I don't know. Just like we to have petty fights, like, over everything, and we wouldn't be questioning each other stuff. We'd be like, oh, what about this? Or I don't know, it's just like, and there was even I even felt like peace. Like if you would be going, like I wouldn't even care. But oh, they have fun. Like, you could text me whenever you're done. Like, I don't want to be checking up on you.

Speaker 1 [00:09:04] Mhm.

Speaker 2 [00:09:04] That was like the most started being peaceful.

Speaker 1 [00:09:08] All right. And what do you say would be, oh, when would you say it was the least quality or the lowest quality?

Speaker 2 [00:09:19] Well, when we met [Name] [1-5] months into knowing each other was the lowest because we were super mature. And I feel like for him, like, I didn't really tell him that. Or we knew we were talking, but I didn't tell him he was serious, seriously, for me. But I never told him because I thought I was. So he was kind of like, Oh, it's a whatever thing for now. And so I was hella frustrated and he was like, why are you frustrated?

Speaker 1 [00:09:53] Right. Okay. So for you, what are the most important things in your relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:10:14] I feel like obviously the love because if you don't love somebody, you're not gonna even try. Then, I would say obviously also loyalty, because how are you going to be in a relationship with each other. And then, the communication? Because that's what was what made my relationship a heck of better. Just the fact that [inaudible].

Speaker 1 [00:10:43] And how do you define love? Like what is love to you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:49] To me, I don't know how to explain it, but like, for him, I would literally I would put him for me. And then it's weird, but, like, I don't know. And like, you remember arguing, like, I don't even think about. I don't know. It's just like I think.

Speaker 1 [00:11:05] Yeah. Take your time.

Speaker 2 [00:11:07] Like when I would argue with other people, like, I just get mad, you know? It doesn't really matter. Like, I'm not going to do anything. With him, like, I would actually listen and be like, okay, let me understand him and can work it out. And like, I want to fight so we can argue and then figure it out and then get to like do things with him that I would never want to do and anybody else who might. And it just feels good.

Speaker 1 [00:11:47] And, hmm, okay. Oh, I guess I asked the next question already. Right. How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:06] Really important.

Speaker 1 [00:12:10] And why?

Speaker 2 [00:12:12] Um, because if love isn't there, then it's hard to have the other stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:12:19] Mhm.

Speaker 1 [00:12:30] And how do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:35] Just little things, like little gestures he does all the time. Like, one thing I've never done when we've been together is open my own car door. He's always doing that, like, until today. Just random little acts. Like little words like, oh, you look really nice. You know, when I'm feeling like sad, he'll see the most perfect things and I'm like, my God, then I'm not doing that anymore. And so, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:13:04] It's really nice. All right. And okay. Yeah. So this is more in depth, but what would you say are challenges in your relationship, even now.

Speaker 2 [00:13:18] Sometimes he still struggles to like we still struggle to do the communication where he wants to shut down. And sometimes I don't get it. And I'm so stuck in my head where I'm like, no, you stuck me. Or like, we need to find the [inaudible]. We still we're still struggling to find where to meet in the middle for that thing.

Speaker 1 [00:13:38] Mm.

Speaker 2 [00:13:39] So that's a struggle we still have today.

Speaker 1 [00:13:53] And you said that you guys have like arguments. How often would you say, your arguments or fights, how often would you say these occur?

Speaker 2 [00:14:07] Probably like one. Like a like an argument. Argument like. One for--

Speaker 1 [00:14:15] Your definition.

Speaker 2 [00:14:18] It's like. Like the definition. Like. Like an argument where when I get mad and I get mad, I feel like it's an argument because it actually turned into something bigger throughout the day and like once every month.

Speaker 1 [00:14:36] And would it be about the same, like the struggles that you mentioned or something different?

Speaker 2 [00:14:43] Yeah, it would be about the same. Like with the only reason we're entering something bigger is because of the meaning in the middle part of that.

Speaker 1 [00:14:49] Mm hmm. Okay. And how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:15:04] I guess like I said, like I, I think about his point of view. So I just end up sucking it up and I'm like, okay, I'll just stay quiet all going for a bit. And then whenever you're ready to talk, just come to me. Whatever. And that's how I usually or he'll be the first one to be like, okay, I'm sorry, I know what I'm doing is wrong. And then he'll talk. It's just I mean, it just nothing happens. Then we fix it.

Speaker 1 [00:15:32] And what are other ways you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:39] We make sure to go out every once in a while because we don't like staying home too much because it's boring and he knows it. And so we always make sure to go out even if it's like a bike ride or a tiger park or anything.

Speaker 1 [00:15:56] Right. Anything else?

Speaker 2 [00:16:00] I sometimes like the little gestures too. Like he'll give me the flowers or I'll get him some clothes or I'll pay for food. Sometimes just for fun. I'm like, Oh, let's go eat. But I'll pay for his food, you know, just like little, little. Just the little gestures.

Speaker 1 [00:16:23] Would you say the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:16:27] I think it is good for me because it helps me mature quite quickly, especially here. Yeah. He helped me mature quickly, because before I'll be a big crybaby. And learning to not be a crybaby. He's also like a really he's a person who goes to church a lot. And I, but I stand by him. But since meeting him, I started going again. Which in my feeling is really good because of what I need. It was good for me, going to church--

Speaker 1 [00:17:01] Right. And did the relationship change you and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:17:15] Um, yeah. It changed me in a way like, not really, it changed me in a way where, like I said, like I matured and I go to church more. But I'm like, I still go have fun with my friends. And so it wasn't a huge change, but just some things. I don't know how to explain it just a little bit.

Speaker 1 [00:17:38] Mm okay. And what about your, your boyfriend? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:45] Um. Yeah, he changed a lot. He used to be rude to me when I met him, he used to be rude to everybody. Like, he would be rude in person. Everybody like, oh, he's me, my roommate. But then I'm also, I'm a really, really nice person, which is why people work for me. That's why we're together. But after being with me, like he's learned to be nice to everybody to, he's more, more friendly.

Speaker 1 [00:18:15] All right. And do you feel safe in the relationship? Why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:18:31] I feel safe because I know he would never hurt me. And I know when I'm here, he'll be there for me. He's always, and he's, like, easily, like, quick finger. So if anything were to happen to us, like, outside of our relationship, like if somebody else something is a quick thing, cause I know he would know what to do in a bad situation, then we'd be fine. So. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:18:57] Right. And for this one, I'll be sharing my screen. And you'll be, just the visualization of the next question. Okay. All right. So the first one is my partner usually really listens to me. How much would you rate it?

Speaker 2 [00:19:38] Seven.

Speaker 1 [00:19:40] And why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:19:42] Because he's very hardheaded. So sometimes if he's really stuck on something, he will [inaudible] anybody and he'll do what he thinks is better.

Speaker 1 [00:19:55] And why did you choose a seven and not a six or not an eight?

Speaker 2 [00:20:01] Not a six because he does listen to me like 90% of the time. But that 10% is what did not make me go and put an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:20:11] All right. Now, the next one, my partner usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:20:25] I would do, the eight.

Speaker 1 [00:20:30] And why not a seven or why not a nine?

Speaker 2 [00:20:34] Not a seven? Because when he can, he will. He'll do what he can. But not the nine because sometimes he, sometimes he's really, really busy. So it's not his fault. But that's why it's not like all the time.

Speaker 1 [00:20:55] And how satisfied are you with your relationship? From completely satisfied to completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:21:02] The very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:21:08] And again, why not somehow satisfied or completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Somewhat satisfied not, because I know I'm happy, but I'm not completely because I know we can still do a lot of stuff that'll make us better.

Speaker 1 [00:21:30] All right. And how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:38] The nine. Kind of the same with the last one.

Speaker 1 [00:21:40] Okay. Yeah. Sorry. Sorry. All right. And we continue to the next one. All right. So feel free to let me know if you're not comfortable with answering these is just two questions, and it's regarding your sex life. Would you like to continue?

Speaker 2 [00:22:24] Yeah, that's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:22:26] Okay, So. All right. Yeah. So I wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple these these days. How often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:22:37] Like three times a week.

Speaker 1 [00:22:41] Okay. And how satisfied are you with your sex life and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:22:48] Um, I'm really satisfied because he always make sure that me and him are both good.

Speaker 1 [00:23:03] All right. So moving on. All right. So in... All right. So, yeah, we're pretty much done. I'm just going to, like, make a summary of everything we talked about. So you are [16-20] years old. You've been together with your with your boyfriend for [6-10] months and you have [1-5] children that you're with.

Speaker 2 [00:23:31] Sorry. It's [1-5] year and [6-10] months.

Speaker 1 [00:23:33] Okay. [1-5] year and [6-10] months. You live with your mom, dad and brother. And your source of income is working on a [company] in a [company] doing some writing. And you guys. So in terms of your love story, you were, you used to work at [Country] and as a [occupation]. And then he asked you how old you were and went for your number. And then you talked on the same day and on the phone. And then [6-10] months later, you became official. And the first [1-5] weeks in the first [1-5] weeks that you guys had known each other, you had a party where he came over and that's where he met your parents and let's see. And in terms of the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationship, the relationships of your friends are hard and yours is hard, too, but over time, it's become an increase in quality. So the qualities you said is average, and over time it's gotten pretty settled and like a good quality. The reason why is because he tends to shut down and he needs time to himself. And then you tend to want to address things on the spot. So there's that. Trying to find a common ground. And then you said you've had [1-5] romantic partner in the past and it was nothing serious that sometimes you don't even count it and you mainly just hung out and didn't really talk about anything serious. But compared to your current relationship, it's pretty much the opposite of that. You are serious about each other. You treat each other well. And you said he knows, talks about. Yeah. And just mainly like serious conversations and being serious with each other.

Speaker 1: And then, for what makes a relationship high quality or low quality. You said that high would mean getting through situations by communication and then low being pretty much the opposite. So avoiding and not caring. You talked about how in the

beginning of [Month] and [Month] of this year, it started becoming, the relationship started settling in and becoming of higher quality because of like more communication being in the relationship. And then you said it was normal as well. There's no more petty fights or questioning, so you feel more at peace. And then for what is the most important thing in a relationship? You said that love and meaning, like feeling the love, putting the other person before yourself, listening, understanding, and wanting to do things together. And it just feels good, and you said loyalty and communication. And, for how important love is in a relationship. You said it's really important because without it it's hard to have the other stuff that you kind of need for a relationship to work out. And you know, your partner loves you because he does little things like little gestures, opening the car door, compliments, and words of affirmation.

Speaker 1: And then some challenges are that sometimes sometimes you struggle with communication. He wants to shut down or you want to talk about the situation or address the situation. So again, finding that common ground. And then you said you guys probably fight around once every month and again trying to meet in the middle. But the way you guys resolve this is by talking to each other and like trying to understand each other's point of view. And then other ways that you guys maintain the relationship is by going out, doing activities together and again, doing small gestures with each other, like paying food, buying things for each other. And you said that the relationship overall is pretty good for you because it's helped you mature and you don't cry as much and you guys are able to go to church together. And you said that the relationship, because of that, has changed you again, you've become mature and you go out with friends more. And then you said that your boyfriend also changed, he used to be rude. And now he smiles, because mainly because of your influence of having a nice demeanor. And then you said you feel safe in the relationship because he would hurt you and as a quick thinker. And now I'm looking at my other notes. You said, a 7, for my partner usually really listens to me because you said he's hardheaded and doesn't really listen. But that's mainly for the 10% left from the 90% where he does listen. And then my partner is usually responsive to my needs, you said, um, you said an eight because when he can, he will and not a nine. Because it's not all the time that he's responsive to your needs. And then, all right. So in terms of your sex life, you guys do it three times a week. And you said you're really satisfied because you guys to make sure that each other are like, good in the moment. And yeah, that's pretty much it. Is there anything you like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:30:10] No, that's pretty good.

Speaker 1 [00:30:12] All right. And. Yeah, so we're done. So thank you so much. And now, before we end, I wanted to talk to you about how we handle the data as a research project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible. So I wanted to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with, looking at the form that you signed. You said that you're comfortable with the full transcription except sensitive detail. Is are you still like, do you still agree with that or would you like to change that?

Speaker 2 [00:30:48] Um, everything is fine with being shared. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:30:52] And all right. So, again, thank you so much. And I would like to let you know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and throughout the US. And for this study to be successful, there's also one more thing that I will like to ask you if that's okay for you. Can you recommend like to close people in your life as a nominator? We would like we would ask them for like additional couples that might be interested in the study and basically like a snowballing effect and we'll, will ask them for

a couple that you don't really know or interact with. And this way we can get as diverse and network as we can get. Is that okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:31:42] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:31:43] All right. So. Yeah, so. Yeah. So just, like, lead them to the solar thing that you that you did and then let me know if you do end up like finding someone based on the criteria that I sent over. And if you do, like, let me know. So then I could email them and please let them know as well. So, you know, give them a heads up so they don't block, yeah. And then yeah, yeah, that's pretty much it. And just yeah, just one more thing in terms of meeting or doing the interview with your boyfriend, do you happen to have his schedule on hand so I could like send an email or something?

Speaker 2 [00:32:28] So his email is his [redacted] because he just really uses email.

Speaker 1 [00:32:35] Okay? Yeah, that's fine.

Speaker 2 [00:32:37] Okay. His. Don't you want me give you the number? Yeah. Okay. It's [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:32:48] Wait.

Speaker 2 [00:32:49] [Number].

Speaker 1 [00:32:54] Hmm. All right. And what is his name?

Speaker 2 [00:33:04] [Name].

Speaker 1 [00:33:07] All right. Got it. All right. So, yeah, I'll try to see if he's available sometime this week. And yeah, so thank you so much.